

DoView Tool F5 - When Public League-Tabling is Appropriate Checklist

F5

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Public league-tabling - where the performance of one organization, agency, provider, policy or initiative is ranked against the performance of other initiatives is increasingly being used. This checklist can be used to assess whether public, private or no league-tabling is the best option.

1. Do the people or units serviced by the different initiatives vary in their initial levels of the outcome measures being compared? IF YES, DON'T PUBLIC LEAGUE TABLE. Can improvement (value-added) be measured rather than just raw scores? IF YES, CONSIDER PUBLIC LEAGUE-TABLING.
2. Is the outcomes measurement approach robust enough to prevent manipulation or gaming arising from the high stakes of comparisons being made public? IF NOT, DON'T PUBLIC LEAGUE TABLE. CONSIDER PRIVATE LEAGUE-TABLING IF GAMING WILL BE LESS LIKELY BECAUSE THE STAKES ARE LOWER. Is it feasible and affordable to make measurement more robust by involving a third party? IF YES, CONSIDER PUBLIC LEAGUE-TABLING.
3. Will the high stakes of the comparisons drive measurement towards a trade-off of validity (actually measuring exactly what you want) against reliability (being able to affordably get a non-contested measure)? IF YES, DON'T PUBLIC LEAGUE TABLE. Can measurement be pushed more towards validity rather than just reliability? IF YES, CONSIDER LEAGUE-TABLING.
4. Will public league tabling create client flight and threaten the viability of institutions that should not be damaged or eliminated? IF YES, DON'T LEAGUE-TABLE. CONSIDER PRIVATE LEAGUE-TABLING. IN ADDITION, CONSIDER THE ADDITION OF AN 'ASSIST' MODE. (See When to Include an 'Assist' plus an 'Assess' Mode in Contracting Checklist (E7)).